

Kodak Z612

Compact and feature heavy

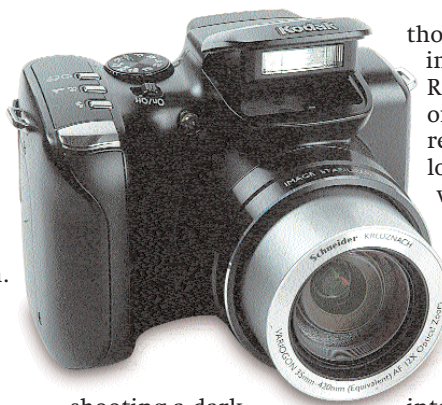
Kodak's Z612 is positioned as a compact ultra-zoom. The 6.1 MP sensor, Schneider-Kreuznach optics, and Optical Image Stabilisation mean the Z612 is no slouch when it comes to serious photography. A delightful 12x optical zoom means you won't miss out on long-distance shots, and IS (image stabilisation) complements this, especially considering the chances of blur increase at the wide-end of tele-zoom.

Button placement is very good. There are a lot of discrete buttons for quick access to essential features. The menu, too, is very well-laid-out, intuitive even for beginners. There's an ultra convenient click-wheel that allows adjusting of essential parameters like Exposure Compensation, ISO, Aperture, and Shutter Speed in full manual mode.

For such a large zoom, there are too few steps, and the zoom tends to race ahead. The oversensitive zoom button compounds the problem.

Image quality: one problem is the Optical IS doesn't work as well as expected in continuous mode, which is the recommended mode for least camera shake. Setting IS to single mode doesn't make things any better.

At auto settings, image quality is good for close-ups; however, as with most non-D-SLR cameras, the flash range is limited to under nine feet. The Z612 produces great detailing outdoors. The Z612 is unforgiving to the newbie—you should know exactly what you're doing while shooting using manual settings. Some of our outdoor shots, especially



those models offer better image quality. At Rs 19,999, the Kodak Z612 offers all the features, at a reduced price and slightly lower quality. Buy it if you want something



shooting a dark subject with bright sunlight in the background produced a purple tinge.

Overall a good camera for casual clickers, and very feature-rich and functional. The specifications position the Z612 in the league of Canon's S3IS and Sony's DSC-H1. Although costlier,

intermediate and are somewhat financially limited.

Specifications

Max resolution 2848 x 2144 (6.1 MP); ISO 80 ~ 400 (800 @ 1 MP); lens 35 ~ 420 (W-T); aperture range F2.8 ~ F4.8; shutter range 16 ~ 1/2000; video 640 x 480 @ 30 fps; expansion SD/MMC (32 MB inbuilt); Li-ion 1600 mAh supplied

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Settings & Options	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

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Price: Rs. 19,999/-

IOGEAR Wireless Laser Travel Mouse1600 GME227R

Precision and value in a small package

The IOGEAR GME227R is a portable wireless laser mouse primarily aimed at laptop users. It features in an antibacterial coating of titanium dioxide and silver nano-particle compound. This coating prevents bacteria from surviving on the surface of the device.

The ergonomics of this little mouse is asymmetric, and the design suits a right-handed person. It is wireless, is powered by 2 AAA batteries, and weighs only 82 grams—light enough for comfortable use.

The GME227R has a 1600 dpi resolution, which is more than enough for regular use. The USB wireless transmitter effectively covers a distance of about 6 feet. The mouse also features a power switch at its base to conserve batteries when not in use. It's a universal



plug-and-play device—no drivers required; it supports Mac as well.

The mouse is so nimble as to respond to even the smallest of hand movements. Tracking is

sensitive enough for speedy word processing and office use. The tactile feel of the right and the left clicks are delicate, whereas the vertical scroll wheel, integrated with the middle click, is slightly stiffer. The small size is a problem for prolonged use, as in a gaming session. A snap-in USB transmitter is missing; its inclusion would

improve the portability of the product.

The package contains an extremely useful USB extension, and also a velvet pouch. There is a comprehensive manual and a 3-year limited warranty.

This is a decent laptop mouse, and best suited for regular office applications. Rs 3,000 is a little steep for a mouse.

Specifications

Resolution - 1600 dpi; battery - 2 x AAA; operating frequency 27 MHz; 256 channel IDs; 6 - 8 kHz band; dimensions: (mouse) 3.74 (L) x 1.97 (W) x 1.18 (H) inches; weight: mouse 82 gm, receiver 18 gm

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

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